

03 Using collocations

Collocations are often formed of two words, but can contain more. Using them will make you a more fluent English speaker.

⚙️ **New language** Collocations

Aa **Vocabulary** Beliefs and opinions

🧩 **New skill** Talking about your life

3.1 KEY LANGUAGE COLLOCATIONS

Collocations are pairs or groups of words that naturally go together and sound "right" to experienced users of a language.



He has a **low opinion** of the film. ✓

He has a **light opinion** of the film. ✗

"Light" can have a similar meaning to "low" ("not much"), but does not sound natural next to "opinion."

There was **light rain** forecast today. ✓

There was **low rain** forecast today. ✗

"Low" can have a similar meaning to "light," but does not collocate with "rain."



Aa

3.2 FILL IN THE GAPS USING THE WORDS IN THE PANEL TO CREATE MORE COLLOCATIONS

It is **extremely unlikely** that there will be a happy ending.

① She doesn't have any **family** left, only an uncle.

② Sometimes the only solution is to **your best** and hope.

③ All their lives they appeared to be **married**.

④ Unfortunately, the financial crisis **ruined his**.

⑤ He first **into business** when he was only 17.

⑥ Looking at old photographs can **stir up**.

⑦ I can **distinctly** meeting him 20 years ago.

⑧ Looking at them, the difference in age is **visible**.

close

career

went

do

happily

~~unlikely~~

memories

clearly

remember

